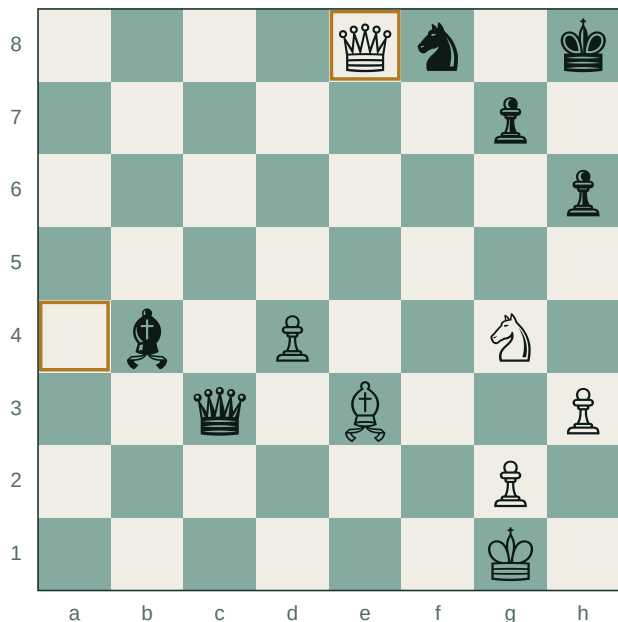


Deflection tactics: Black, move 31

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Qe8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Qe1+ 32. Kh2 Bd6+ 33. Ne5 Qxe3

31...Qe1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From e1 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **32.Kh2**.

32...Bd6+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **33.Ne5**.

33...Qxe3 The queen captures the bishop on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e8. Check for tactical protection.